Ziqi Yang

University of California, Irvine

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Expected Graduation Date: 06/2029

Introduction

I have a multidisciplinary background in electrical and computer engineering, industrial design, and information science. In my research in Human-Computer Interaction, I conduct mixed-method studies to understand people in home, family, and women's health contexts, and design and build systems with generative AI to support better tracking and sharing of personal health information.

Education

2024-2029 (Expected) **Ph.D. in Informatics**, *University of California, Irvine*
Advisor: Yunan Chen, Daniel Epstein

2021-2023 **M.S. in Information**, *University of Michigan, Ann Arbor*
Focus: Human-Computer Interaction and User Experience
Research Advisor: Mark Newman, Pedja Klasnja

2021-2021 **Visiting Student**, *University of California, Berkeley*

2018-2022 **B.S. in Electrical and Computer Engineering**, *Shanghai Jiao Tong University*
Research Advisor: Zhanxun Dong

Skills

Programming

Python, C, C++, R, LaTex, JavaScript, CSS, HTML, SQL, Matlab, Shell

Design

Figma, Adobe Creative Cloud (XD, Illustrator, Photoshop), Miro

Publications

C. 4 Ziqi Yang, Daniel Epstein, Yunan Chen
"Sharing Women's Health Experiences Influenced by Genetic Factors: Practices, Challenges, and Opportunities"
Under Review for **CHI'26**

C. 3 Ziqi Yang, Yuxuan Lu, Jennifer Bagdasarian, Vedant Das Swain, Ritu Agarwal, Collin Campbell, Waddah Al-Refaire, Jehan El-Bayoumi, Guodong Gao, Nawar Shara, Dakuo Wang, Bingsheng Yao.
"RECOVER: Designing a Large Language Model-based Remote Patient Monitoring System for Postoperative GI Cancer Care"
Under Review for **CSCW'25**

C.2 Siyi Wu, Weidan Cao, Shihan Fu, Bingsheng Yao, Ziqi Yang, Changchang Yin, Varun Mishra, Daniel Addison, Ping Zhang, and Dakuo Wang. 2025. "CardioAI: A Multimodal AI-based System to Support Symptom Monitoring and Risk Prediction of Cancer Treatment-Induced Cardiotoxicity." **CHI '25**, doi.org/10.1145/3706598.3714272

J.1 Liuqing Chen*, Yu Cai*, Yuyang Fang, Ziqi Yang, Duowei Xia, Jiaxiang You, Shuhong Xiao, Yaxuan Song, Lingwei Zhan, Juanjuan Chen, and Lingyun Sun. "Observing a robot peer's failures facilitates students' classroom learning." **Science Robotics**, 2025, doi.org/10.1126/scirobotics.adu5257

C.1 Ziqi Yang, Xuhai Xu, Bingsheng Yao, Ethan Rogers, Shao Zhang, Stephen Intille, Nawar Shara, Guodong Gordon Gao, and Dakuo Wang. "Talk2Care: An LLM-based Voice Assistant for Communication between Healthcare Providers and Older Adults." **IMWUT'24**, doi.org/10.1145/3659625

Research Experience

2024 – Present **Graduate Student Researcher**, *University of California, Irvine*

Women's Health Systematic Review and Genetic Health Survey [C.4]

- Conducted a **systematic literature review** on women's health in HCI, mapping research trends and identifying design gaps.
- Designed and deployed a **mixed-method survey** with 249 U.S. women to study intergenerational sharing of **genetic health experiences**.
- Analyzed survey data to surface narrative patterns and barriers, informing speculative **design opportunities** for **AI-driven storytelling** and decision-support tools.

2024 **Research Assistant**, *Zhejiang University*

Social Robots and Education [J.1]

- Programmed **Python** scripts for NAO **social robot** and designed a **between-subject experiment** on generative AI–driven embodied learning.
- Applied **quantitative analysis** (learning and emotion scales, ANCOVA) to evaluate knowledge acquisition and emotional outcomes.
- Led **qualitative analysis** using iterative coding and thematic analysis, identifying 23 axial codes and 6 themes (**inter-rater reliability k=0.85**).

2023–2024 **Graduate Student Research Assistant**, *Northeastern University*

LLM-Facilitated Patient–Provider Communication [C.1–C.3]

- Conducted **interviews** with 19 older adults and healthcare providers to uncover communication barriers and design opportunities for **LLM-powered systems**.
- Designed and developed **Talk2Care**, integrating a **voice assistant** (Alexa + Python Lambda) for patients and an information **dashboard** (Figma, React) for providers.
- Ran **mixed-method user studies** (Qualtrics SUS survey + interviews), demonstrating strong usability and surfacing design implications for LLM-mediated communication.
- Tested **LLaMA-2 (7B/13B/70B)** models on Amazon **BedRock** and **SageMaker**, exploring customization, personalization, and scalability for healthcare contexts.
- Facilitated **participatory design sessions** with cancer care providers and patients; developed a GPT-4–enabled monitoring system, **RECOVER**, and conducted multi-stage **deployment studies** and mixed-method evaluation to assess model accuracy.

2022–2024 **Graduate Student Research Assistant**, *University of Michigan, Ann Arbor*

Designing mHealth Interventions

- Prototyped **exercise coach chatbots** (scripts + Figma) with empathy and personality traits to study long-term user–chatbot relationships.
- Conducted **pilot user studies** (n=6) with surveys and interviews; analyzed data from Amazon Mechanical Turk to reveal user preferences in digital health interventions.
- Explored **AI-driven Just-In-Time Adaptive Interventions (JITAI)** using technology probes to promote physical activity.

Work Experience

2024–2025 **User Researcher and Designer, Software Engineer, Co-founder**, *AdmitGen*

- Conducted user research interviews and usability studies to identify student pain points in graduate admission processes.
- Designed and developed an AI-driven prototype that generates tailored admission essay feedback using large language models.
- Collaborated with co-founders to build frontend (React) and backend (Flask, MongoDB) features, enabling scalable user testing.
- Led iterative design cycles, creating Figma wireframes and interactive prototypes to validate with early adopters.

2023 **Product Manager Intern**, *Red (Xiaohongshu)*

- Designed an unbiased sampling hierarchy for the Red social network content ecosystem and developed dashboards for live-streaming features, improving review accuracy by 10%.
- Conducted A/B testing and SQL-based data analysis of sincerity models for search and recommendation systems, improving precision–recall consistency by 5% and achieving human-review stability above 90%.

2023 **Product Manager Intern**, *eBay*

- Performed market research and competitive analysis for Data Lake Studio, supporting big data processing and machine learning pipelines.
- Authored detailed PRDs and roadmaps for access control and data pipeline features; created and iterated on 3 Figma design prototypes based on stakeholder feedback.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to deliver feature updates and improve developer documentation quality.

2022 **User Experience Designer Intern**, *Microsoft*

- Conducted competitive analysis, user personas, and journey mapping for Dynamics 365 supply chain users, informing 5 new feature concepts.
- Designed and delivered mid-fi and hi-fi prototypes for route and formula management features, improving usability of supply chain allocation tools.
- Partnered with PMs and engineers to translate customer insights into actionable product improvements and standardized information architecture.

2019 **Software Engineer Intern**, *Hangzhou InfoCore Technology*

- Implemented Soft-RoCE for multi-tenant cloud backup solutions, improving efficiency of big data workflows.
- Optimized data processing pipelines using Hadoop ecosystem (HDFS, MapReduce) in Java, R, and Python.

Honors & Awards

2025 **Bob & Barbara Kleist Endowed Graduate Fellowship ($3000)**, *School of Informatics and Computer Science, UC Irvine*

2024 **Chair's Award ($2500)**, *School of Informatics and Computer Science, UC Irvine*

2021 **Student Development Scholarship (¥1500)**, *UM-SJTU Joint Institute*

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant

2025 **INF 133 User Interaction Software**, *Instructor: Dr. Daniel Epstein*
2 Quarters

INF 285 Interactive Technology Studio, *Instructor: Dr. Daniel Epstein*

2024 **INF 115 Software Testing and Quality Assurance**, *Instructor: Dr. James Jones*

2020 **VR 245 Introduction to Theatre**, *Instructor: Dr. Ryan Thorpe*

VY 200 Academic English II, *Instructor: Dr. Ryan Thorpe*

2019 **VY 100 Academic English I**, *Instructor: Dr. Ryan Thorpe*

Talks and Presentations

2024 **UbiComp**, *Paper Presentation: Talk2Care: An LLM-based Voice Assistant for Communication between Healthcare Providers and Older Adults.*

Professional Service

Conference and Journal Review

2025 **CHI 2026 Full Papers**, *3*

Mensch und Computer 2025 Short Papers, *1*

DIS 2025 Pictorials, *1*

IMWUT Full Paper, *1*

2024 **CHI 2025 Late Breaking Work**, *2*

CHI 2025 Full Paper, *3*

Student Mentorship

2025 **Lauren Lee**, *University of Califronia, Irvine*

Anagha Rao, *University of Califronia, Irvine*

2022 **Qingzhou Ma**, *University of Michigan, Ann Arbor*

Professional Membership

2024-Present **Grad Society of Women Engineers**, *University of California, Irvine*